

Acme Corp ? Employee Handbook & Human Resources Policy

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****Effective Date:**** January 1, 2026

****Applicability:**** All Full-time and Part-time Employees of Acme Corporation

****Document Owner:**** Global People & Culture Operations

1. Introduction & Company Overview

Welcome to Acme Corp ("the Company"). At Acme Corp, our mission is to deliver intelligent enterprise software solutions that drive growth and innovation.

This Employee Handbook and HR Policy document outlines the terms, benefits, standards of conduct, and workplace expectations for all employees.

2. Working Hours & Attendance

2.1 Standard Work Week

* ****Standard Hours:**** The standard work week consists of ****40 hours****, typically scheduled Monday through Friday.

* ****Core Hours:**** Acme Corp operates on a ****Core Working Hours**** model between ****10:00 AM and 4:00 PM**** in Eastern Standard Time.

* ****Flexible Scheduling:**** Employees may adjust their start and finish times outside core hours (e.g., 7:30 AM to 4:00 PM).

2.2 Time Tracking and Overtime

* Salaried exempt employees are evaluated based on deliverables, milestone completion, and meeting objectives rather than strict hours.

* Non-exempt hourly employees must log all hours using the Acme People Portal. Overtime work (exceeding 40 hours per week) is compensated at 1.5x the regular rate.

3. Remote & Hybrid Work Policy

Acme Corp embraces a modern, flexible hybrid work philosophy that balances individual autonomy with in-person collaboration and team cohesion.

3.1 Hybrid Schedule

* ****Office & Remote Allocation:**** Eligible full-time employees are permitted to work remotely up to ****3 days per week****.

* ****Anchor Days:**** Each department head designates specific in-office "Anchor Days" (typically Tuesdays and Thursdays).

3.2 Fully Remote Arrangements

* Fully remote arrangements (100% remote) require formal approval from both the Department Vice President and the HR Department.

* Employees on fully remote contracts must maintain a dedicated, ergonomic home workspace with a reliable high-speed internet connection.

3.3 Home Office Equipment & Stipend

* ****One-time Setup Allowance:**** Acme Corp provides a one-time, non-taxable home office reimbursement stipend of \$1,000.

* ****Company Hardware:**** The IT department provides a standard laptop (MacBook Pro or ThinkPad), noise-cancelling headphones, and a desk set.

3.4 Work from Anywhere & Location Constraints

- * For legal, tax compliance, and payroll withholding reasons, employees must perform all work from their designated office.
- * Temporary international remote work ("Workation") is permitted for up to **15 business days per calendar year**, subject to prior approval.

4. Paid Time Off (PTO) & Leave Entitlements

Acme Corp believes that rest and rejuvenation are essential for sustainable productivity and employee well-being.

4.1 Annual Leave (Vacation)

- * **Entitlement:** All regular full-time employees are entitled to **25 paid annual leave days** per calendar year (accrued pro-rata).
- * **Part-time Employees:** Part-time staff receive annual leave on a pro-rata basis proportional to their contracted hours.
- * **Carryover Policy:** Employees are encouraged to utilize their full leave balance each year. A maximum of **5 unused days** may be carried over to the following year.
- * **Request Process:** Leave requests of 3 consecutive days or more must be submitted through the Acme People platform at least 30 days in advance.

4.2 Sick & Medical Leave

- * **Paid Sick Days:** Employees receive **10 paid sick leave days** per calendar year, available on January 1st of each year.
- * **Notification:** Employees must notify their direct manager via Slack or email prior to 8:30 AM on the day of illness.
- * **Medical Certification:** A valid medical certificate from a licensed healthcare practitioner is mandatory for any sick leave exceeding 3 consecutive days.
- * **Unused Sick Leave:** Unused sick days do not roll over to subsequent years and are not eligible for cash payout.

4.3 Parental Leave

- * **Primary Caregivers:** 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave for the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child.
- * **Secondary Caregivers:** 6 weeks of fully paid parental leave.
- * Parental leave can be taken at any point within the first 12 months following the child's birth or official placement.

4.4 Bereavement Leave

- * Employees are granted up to **5 consecutive paid business days** of bereavement leave in the event of the loss of an immediate family member.
- * Up to **3 consecutive paid business days** are provided for extended family members (grandparent, in-law).

5. Employee Expenses & Reimbursement

- * **Expense Submission:** Business-related travel, client hospitality, and professional development expenses must be submitted within 60 days.
- * **Daily Meal Allowance (Per Diem):** While traveling for business, a per diem meal allowance of **\$75 USD per day** is provided.
- * **Approval Hierarchy:** Expenses under \$1,000 require Direct Manager approval. Expenses exceeding \$1,000 require Finance Department approval.

6. Code of Conduct & Information Security

6.1 Confidentiality & Intellectual Property

- * All work products, code, documentation, designs, and innovations developed during employment at Acme Corp are the property of Acme Corp.
- * Employees must sign and uphold the Acme Confidentiality & Proprietary Information Agreement (CPIA).

6.2 Data Security & AI Usage

- * Employees must not paste confidential customer data, proprietary source code, or internal financial metrics into unsecured email or public forums.
- * The internal Acme Knowledge Agent (running on secure, private enterprise infrastructure) is the designated, authorized tool for internal information searches.
- * Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is strictly mandatory across all corporate accounts and SSO portals.

7. Performance Management & Probation

- * **Probationary Period:** All new hires undergo a standard **90-day probationary period**. During this period, performance is closely monitored.
- * **Annual Reviews:** Acme Corp conducts bi-annual performance evaluations in June (mid-year calibration) and December (annual review).

8. Separation of Employment & Notice Periods

8.1 Notice Period for Resignation

Employees wishing to resign from their position must provide formal written notice to their Line Manager and Human Resources.

- * **During Probationary Period:** A minimum notice period of **14 calendar days** is required.
- * **Standard Full-Time Staff (Post-Probation):** A minimum notice period of **30 calendar days (1 month)** is required.
- * **Senior Management (Director, VP, Executive level):** A minimum notice period of **60 calendar days (2 months)** is required.

8.2 Garden Leave & Pay in Lieu

- * Acme Corp reserves the right to place an employee on paid garden leave or provide pay in lieu of notice during the notice period.

8.3 Offboarding & Asset Return

- * On or before the final day of employment, the employee must return all Acme-owned equipment, security tokens, and access credentials.
- * Final pay, including accrued but unpaid annual leave, will be processed in the next scheduled standard payroll cycle.

9. HR Operations & Contact Information

For inquiries regarding benefits, leave balances, or policy clarifications, contact:

- * **HR Helpdesk:** 'hr-support@acmecorp.internal'
- * **People Portal:** 'https://people.acmecorp.internal'
- * **Confidential Ethics Hotline:** '1-800-555-ACME-ETHICS'